

A Dose-Ranging Study of Riluzole in Amyotrophic Lateral Sclerosis

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BACKGROUND: Riluzole (Rilutek) modulates glutamatergic transmission and has been shown to prolong survival in patients with amyotrophic lateral sclerosis (ALS).

RESULTS: Survival at 18 months was significantly higher for patients receiving riluzole (100 mg/day) compared to placebo. The relative risk of death was reduced by 35% in the active treatment group.

CONCLUSION: Riluzole is safe and effectively prolongs survival or time to tracheostomy in patients with ALS, establishing it as the first disease-modifying therapy for this fatal condition.